

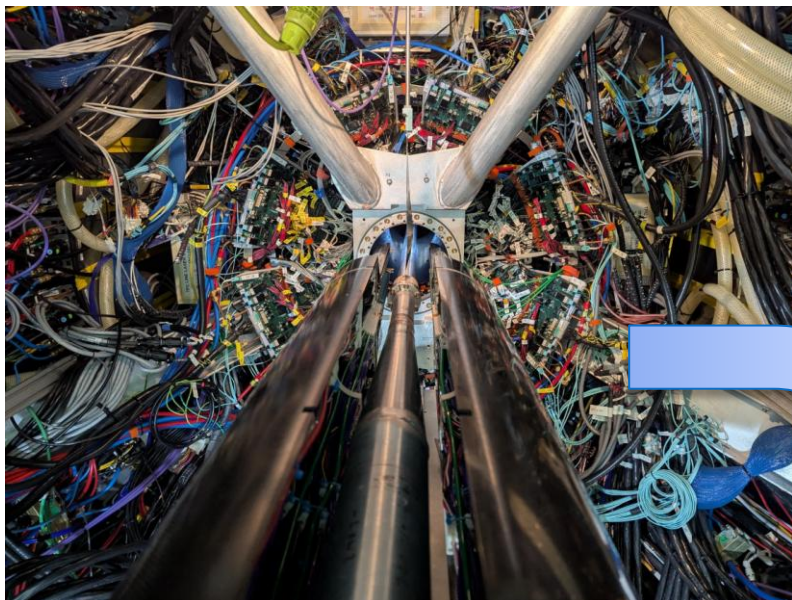
218th sPHENIX Fortnightly Meeting

Megan Connors (GSU), Jin Huang (BNL)

April 24, 2026



R&R progress from 1008



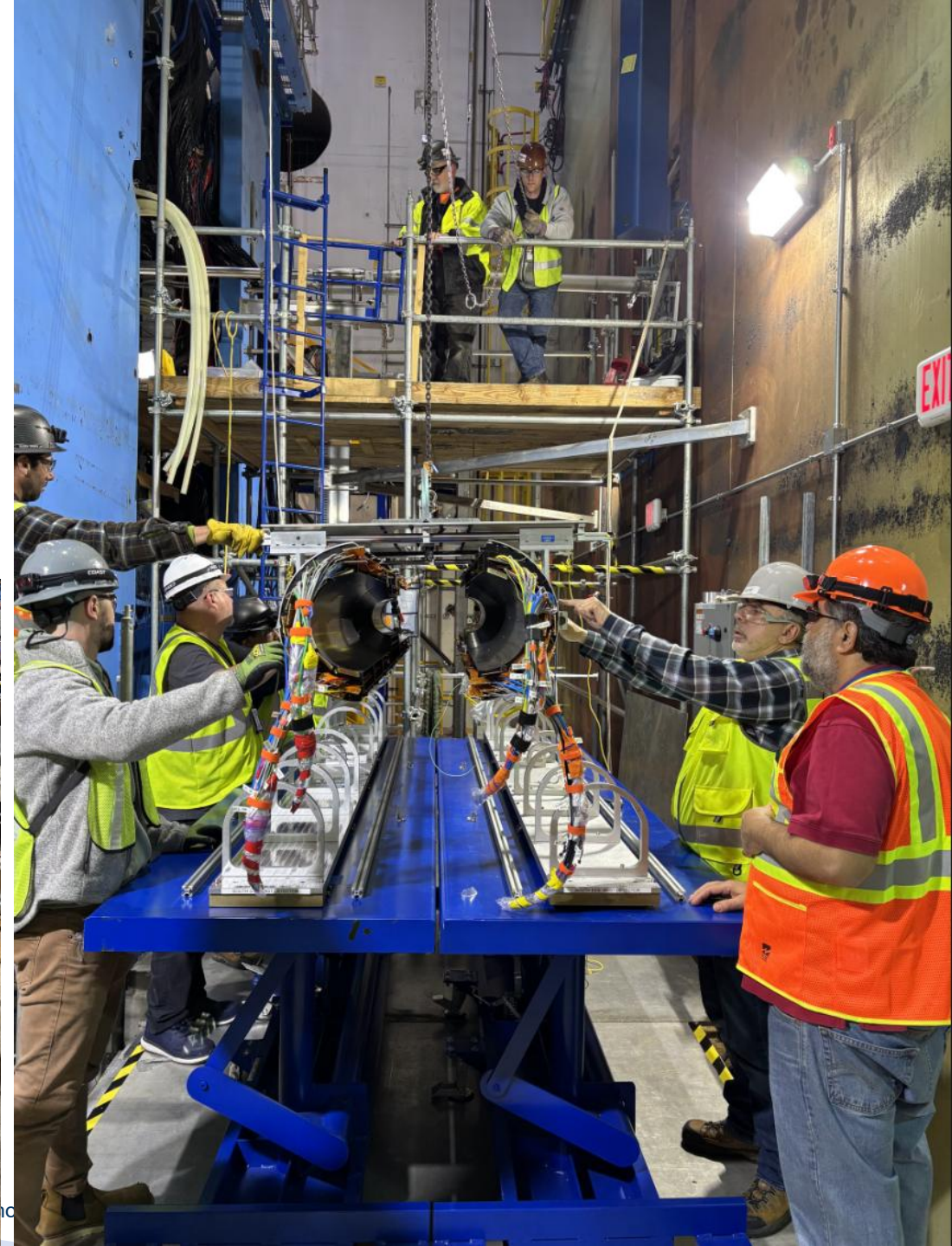
Apr 8, MVTX extracted
photo from Cameron Dean

Apr 22, INTT extraction
photo from Sean Stoll

INTT now in Physics
Ladder to be extracted, to
be sent to RIKEN/Taiwan



Apr 9, INTT ROC removal
photo from Sean Stoll



US NP Research Funding Related Updates

- ▶ President's FY27 budget posted
 - Proposes a \$1.1B cut to DOE Office of Science
 - In previous cycle, Congress did not enact the cuts proposed in the president's budget
- ▶ New since last GM (more on next slides):
 - Last week: sPHENIX US research group survey
 - Friday Apr 17: User group visit to DOE SC/HENP leadership
 - Tuesday April 21: in Washington DC: Nuclear Physics DC Day

sPHENIX US research group survey – April update

- ▶ Survey to sPHENIX IB members on US-based group funding status
 - Thank you to those that quickly completed the form!
 - Additional responses still welcome! (Contact Megan if you cannot locate the email)
- ▶ Provided as the current snapshot for the ALD meeting with NP program managers, User Group advocacy, and NP DC day
- ▶ 13 responses received last week:
 - Significant impacts for groups both renewing and continuing and to all sPHENIX analysis areas
 - Approximately 60% of groups are awaiting outcome of renewal proposal this cycle
 - Funding uncertainty also for groups with existing funding

Joint visit of User Group chairs to DOE SC&HENP leadership

From Peter Steinberg (RHIC User Group Chair)

April 17: visit by the 5 NP facility user group chairs (RHIC, JLab, FRIB, EIC, ATLAS/ANL)

- ▶ Spoke with representatives from Office of Science (Kirsten Ellis and Harriet Kung)
- ▶ Office of High Energy and Nuclear Physics (Gina Rameika, Sharon Stephenson, Paul Mantica)
- ▶ Productive conversation about the priorities of the agency, their commitment to our research, the growing importance of the Genesis Mission and the need for better communication with the user communities
 - *They pointed out that building new facilities like the EIC without growing budgets will require some changes to the research budget*
- ▶ Communicated the serious concerns of the US research community about the drastic and sudden cuts in FY26

Nuclear Physics Day on Capitol Hill



Nuclear Physics Day
April 21, 2026



Support U.S. Leadership in Nuclear Physics

- ▶ Over 80 nuclear physics scientists across the US gathered in DC on April 21 to share their work with their congressional representatives
- ▶ Packets included material on
 - Facilities including RHIC and EIC
 - General benefits of NP for society
 - An “ask” for FY 2027
- ▶ Discussions included importance of balance & current situation with FY 2026



TN delegation with Senators Hagerty & Blackburn

Our Requests for FY 2027:

1. Support at least \$887 million for the DOE-SC Nuclear Physics program in FY 2027. This amount is consistent with the funding levels provided for FY 2026, plus a 2.4% inflation adjustment, in support of the priorities of the 2023 NSAC Long Range Plan. This request for FY 2027 focuses on maintaining balance within the program's budget portfolio among research across the spectrum of the Nuclear Physics community, workforce development, facility operations, new facility construction, and support for the application of artificial intelligence (AI). Ensuring this balance in FY 2027 will help guarantee long-term innovation in nuclear physics and support the innovative use of AI in nuclear physics to aid the success of the Genesis Mission.

2. Support overall funding for the Office of Science in FY 2027 at \$9.5 billion, which is the same level supported by the Energy Sciences Coalition of academic and industry organizations.

3. Support science funding for the NSF in FY 2027. NSF funding supports essential components of the nuclear physics portfolio within the 2023 NSAC Long Range Plan. NSF funding would support research on neutrinoless double beta decay, spanning both theory and experiment, as well as new approaches in theoretical, computational, and experimental research that explore the fundamental laws of physics, the behavior of physical systems, and astrophysical phenomena.

Important dates for upcoming conferences

Conference Name (start date)	IRC Request (paper)	IRC Request (conf. note)	conf. note cir.	first paper draft cir.	second paper draft cir.
Hard Probes (June 20, 2026)	April 25th, 2026	May 9th, 2026	June 6th, 2026	May 16th, 2026	June 6th, 2026
DIS (May 8, 2026)	March 13th, 2026	March 27th, 2026	April 24th, 2026	April 3th, 2026	April 24th, 2026

- ▶ PPG07 completed first circulation:
 - Thanks to the hard work of PPG/IRC and many comments from many collaborators!
 - Paper revision will continue past DIS26
- ▶ Given the busy period ahead of HP, PPGs are advised to circulate paper and ConfNote well ahead of the deadlines above.

RHIC/AGS Users' Meeting

- ▶ <https://www.bnl.gov/rhicagsaum/> ← registration open
 - May 11-12 Workshop
 - May 12-13 Plenary Session
 - May 14-15 RHIC Science Symposium
- ▶ All students and post-docs are invited to submit posters.
 - Posters **will be presented** on Tuesday, May 12
 - Poster Registration deadline: Monday, May 4.
 - A cash prize will be awarded for the best student/post-doc poster presentation, and the winner will give a 10-minute flash talk on Wednesday, May 13.
 - Further details regarding Poster Session can be found here: [Poster Session](#).

2026 RHIC/AGS ANNUAL USERS' MEETING / RHIC SCIENCE SYMPOSIUM

The Apex of RHIC Physics Resolving the Strong Force

May 11-15, 2026

Topical Workshops: May 11-12

Plenary Sessions: May 12-13

2026 Special Symposium: May 14-15

RHIC/AGS Users' Executive Committee

Daniel Brandenburg,
Chair-Elect

Abhay Deshpande,
Associate Laboratory Director
Nuclear and Particle Physics
& EIC Science Director

Anders Knospe,
Past Chair

Peter Steinberg,
Chair

Meeting Coordinators

Kelly Guiffreda
guiffreda@bnl.gov

Christine Immel
cimmel@bnl.gov

Teri Lazar
tlazar@bnl.gov



Summer Planning

- ▶ **June 19-20**: Pre Hard Probes meeting at Vanderbilt [\[link & Registration\]](#)
- ▶ **June 21-26**: Hard Probes Conference
- ▶ **June 27-29**: Post Hard Probes satellite workshop at Georgia State [\[link\]](#)
- ▶ **July 7-10**: Summer Collaboration Meeting hosted by RIKEN in Wako, Japan [\[link & Registration\]](#)
- ▶ **July 27-August 14**: sPHENIX summer school and analysis workfests at BNL with student travel support from RIKEN [\[link & Registration\]](#)

JUNE 2026						
Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
	1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26	27
28	29	30				

JULY 2026						
Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
			1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	

AUGUST 2026						
Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
						1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22
23	24	25	26	27	28	29
30	31					

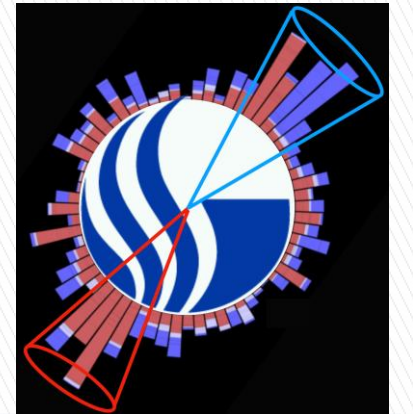
Before & after HP2026

- ▶ Thanks to Vanderbilt hosting the preHP26 meeting
- ▶ Two-day meeting for talk rehearsals



June 19-20: Pre Hard Probes meeting at Vanderbilt [[link & Registration](#)]

- ▶ Focus on Jets and Heavy-Flavor probes
- ▶ Discussions on new and future results
- ▶ **Abstract Due May 1!**
- ▶ Good opportunity to connect with theorist



June 27-29: Post Hard Probes satellite workshop at Georgia State [[link](#)]

Calibration Status

- ▶ Keep updating calibration status:
 - https://wiki.sphenix.bnl.gov/index.php?title=Calibration_in_formation
 - Please edit with status, AnaNote links or contact person
- ▶ Now also include working group assignment
 - Thanks to inputs from many conveners

Snapshot of part of the summary table

Calibration	Responsible Working Group	Run 24 p+p	Run 24 Au+Au	Run 25 Au+Au	Run 25 p+p	Run 25 O+O
MBD	Calo Calibration?					
ZDC	Calo Calibration?					
sEPD	Calo Calibration?					
EMCal - Initial Calib	Calo Calibration	Complete	Complete	Complete	In progress	Complete
EMCal - time dep.		Complete	Complete	in progress		Doc? In progress
		Run 23 AnaNote				
HCal - cosmics	Calo Calibration	Complete	Complete	In progress	In progress	In progress
HCal - beam corr.		Complete	Complete			
HCal - time dep.		Complete	Complete			
centrality	Bulk TG	N/A	Complete AnaNote			
Luminosity counting	?	Luminosity counting largely finished but dependent on final Vernier scan number; contact Joey Clement joseph.clement@colorado.edu or JaeBeom Park jpark4@bnl.gov				
Vernier Scan Analysis						

General Meeting Agenda

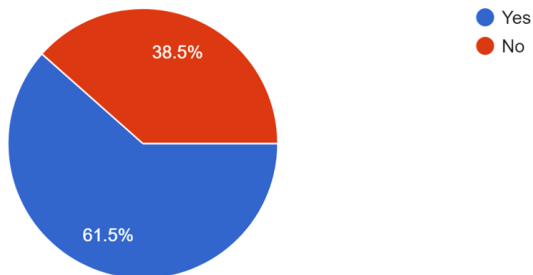
12:00	→ 12:20	Collaboration news	🕒 20m	📝 ▼
Speakers: Dr Jin Huang (Brookhaven National Lab), Megan Connors (Georgia State University)				
12:25	→ 12:35	Speaker's bureau news	🕒 10m	📝 ▼
Speaker: Marzia Rosati (Iowa State University (mrosatl@iastate.edu))				
12:40	→ 12:50	Computing/production news	🕒 10m	📝 ▼
Speakers: Chris Pinkenburg (BNL), Joe Osborn (Brookhaven National Laboratory), Shuhang Li (Columbia University), Thomas Marshall (University of California - Los Angeles)				
12:55	→ 13:15	Report from TPC calibration workshop ALICE / sPHENIX	🕒 20m	📝 ▼
Speakers: Anthony Frawley (Florida State University), Christof Roland (MIT), Joe Osborn (Brookhaven National Laboratory)				

»» Extra Information

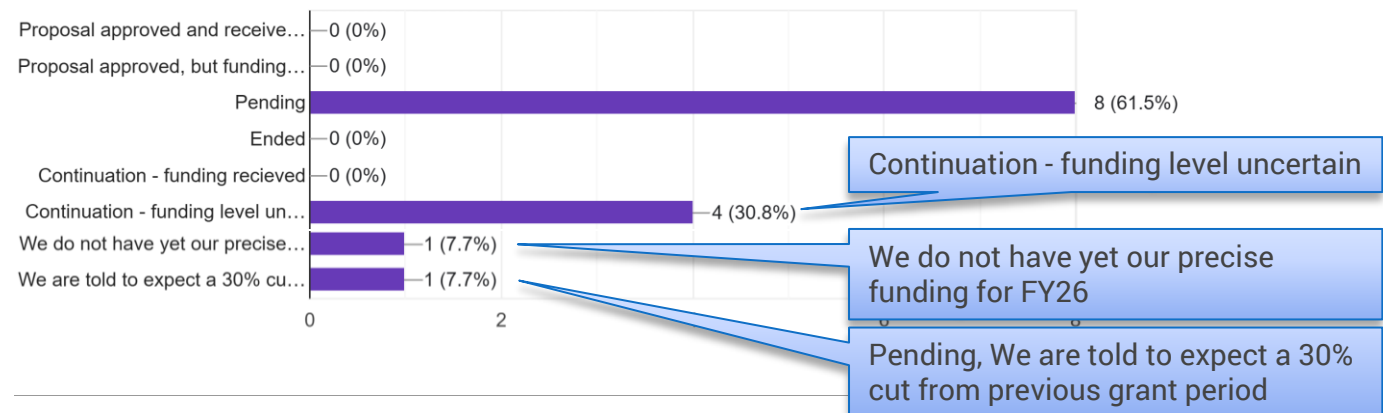
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Did you submit a renewal this cycle on Nuclear Physics research grant supporting sPHENIX work:
13 responses



What is the current status of your funding?
13 responses



Upcoming Collaboration Events

Registration 

- ▶ June 19-20: Pre Hard Probes meeting at Vanderbilt [[link & Registration](#)]
- ▶ June 27-29: Post Hard Probes satellite workshop at Georgia State [[link](#)]
- ▶ July 6-10: Summer Collaboration Meeting hosted by RIKEN in Wako, Japan [[link & Registration](#)]
- ▶ July 27-August 14: sPHENIX summer school and analysis workfests at BNL with student travel support from RIKEN [[link & Registration](#)]

Thanks a ton to colleagues at Vanderbilt, GSU and RIKEN for hosting/organizing these events!





- ▶ Many sPHENIX groups are interested in submitting Genesis Mission Proposals
 - Scientific opportunity presented by ExaByte scale scientific data at sPHENIX
 - Knowledge and expertise on the experiment, analysis skills, and physics
- ▶ sPHENIX Genesis Initiative Exchange released last week [\[link\]](#)
 - sPHENIX management team does not endorse or evaluate these initiatives
 - PIs should make connections using their own judgement on what is best for them and their groups.
 - We aim to help each other make the most of every opportunity to sustain and grow the sPHENIX research effort

sPHENIX Genesis Initiative Exchange [\[link\]](#)
(Idea exchanges among sPHENIX collaborators)

Initiative	Focus Area	Institution
Real-time streaming data reduction	14.C	BNL
Generative AI for analysis	14.C	BNL
Foundation Model for NPP	14.A	BNL
Knowledge preservation with LLM	14.C	BNL
Experiment anomaly detection and con ?		BNL/SBU CS
Generative AI for HI simulations & analysis	14.C	BNL
Generative AI for analysis	14.C	Vanderbilt
AI-enabled Quantum Tomography of Nucl	14.C	ORNL
AI/ML-driven high-level triggers for eff	14.C	Purdue
Nuclear data in the AI era [title needs wo	14C	Texas Southern
Foundation model for fastML	14A/C	LANL
Foundation models	14.A	SBU
Big data meets theory	14.C	SBU
Foundation Model extension to calorimet	14.A	Colorado
Extension of CycleGAN subtraction to jet	14.C	Colorado

Juniors TEA Time and TEA Talks

- We now have a sizeable archive of talks geared towards newer collaborators with recordings and slides [here](#)!
- *Upcoming TEA Talk: Introduction to INTT by Cheng-Wei Shih on March 17th, 2026 at 12pm EST*
- If you have suggestions or want to give a TEA Talk, please contact Bade and Muhammad Shahid!
- sPHENIX Juniors TEA Time Every Tuesday at 12pm EST
- Get connected:
 - [sPHENIX Juniors MatterMost Channel](#)
 - [BNL mailing list](#)
- Want to donate to the sPHENIX Juniors pizza/social fund?
 - Venmo: @bademsi
 - Zelle: badesayki@gmail.com



Megan Connors (GSU), Jin Huang

